

CERTIFICATION AND COMPLIANCE OVERVIEW

BSF-QMS-002

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Purpose

This overview explains how BlueSea Foods organizes certification obligations, operational evidence, audit readiness, and compliance ownership across corporate, HR, HSE, operations, quality, IT, and document control processes.

1. Scope

This document applies to BlueSea Foods corporate functions, seafood receiving and inspection activities, cold chain control, approved vessel sourcing, quality assurance, workplace safety, employee training, document control, and systems access processes that support certification and customer compliance obligations.

It is intended for managers, supervisors, quality personnel, internal auditors, process owners, and employees who generate, review, approve, retain, or retrieve compliance evidence.

- Included: certification framework, process ownership, evidence families, audit preparation, KPIs, risk controls, and document references.
- Excluded: full legal interpretation, customer contract negotiation, third-party certification body procedures, and detailed standard-by-standard clause commentary.

2. Confidentiality

This is a controlled internal document. It may reference audit practices, supplier controls, traceability records, compliance responsibilities, and risk areas that must be protected from unauthorized disclosure.

- External sharing requires approval from the Quality Assurance Manager and Corporate Management.
- Customer-specific requirements may be shared only within the boundaries of the approved commercial or audit relationship.
- Employee, supplier, vessel, system access, and incident records must be handled under applicable access and permissions rules.

3. Compliance Framework

BlueSea Foods uses a layered compliance model. Corporate standards define how documents are controlled; HR and HSE documents define people and safety practices; Operations documents provide receiving, vessel, species, and cold chain controls; Quality documents define induction, certification alignment, and nonconformity management.

Standard	Primary Intent	BlueSea Foods Application	Core Evidence
ISO 9001	Quality management system discipline	Process control, document governance, corrective action, KPI review, customer focus	Controlled procedures, quality objectives, internal audit records, management review
HACCP	Food safety hazard control	Hazard identification and control at receiving, storage, cold chain, and release decision points	Hazard analysis, CCP/OPRP monitoring, deviation and corrective action records
BRCGS Food Safety	Food safety, quality, legality, and operational control	Facility readiness, supplier approval, product inspection, traceability, hygiene, records	Audit files, product release records, hygiene checks, traceability tests
IFS Food	Food safety and quality for processors and	Operational discipline, staff competence, product defense, allergen/contamination controls where	Training, specifications, inspection records, corrective actions

Standard	Primary Intent	BlueSea Foods Application	Core Evidence
	private-label supply	applicable	
MSC Chain of Custody	Certified seafood traceability	Segregation, eligible species confirmation, approved vessel/source controls, mass balance	MSC eligibility checks, receiving records, traceability links, sales/label claims
BASC	Secure international trade and supply chain integrity	Security controls, access, transport review, documentation, incident reporting	Security inspections, access approvals, vessel/transport records, incident logs
SMETA/Sedex	Ethical trade and responsible labor practices	HR records, working hours, benefits, grievance channels, safety practices, management systems	Employee policy records, training, HSE evidence, labor compliance files

4. Governance and Responsibilities

Certification performance is not owned by one department only. The Quality Assurance Manager coordinates the framework, but each process owner is responsible for generating reliable records and closing gaps in their area.

Role	Main Responsibilities	Typical Records
Corporate Management	Approve the compliance policy direction, allocate resources, review systemic risks, and confirm readiness for external audits.	Management review minutes, resource decisions, risk acceptance records
Quality Assurance Manager	Maintain certification overview, coordinate audits, monitor nonconformities, validate corrective action effectiveness, and keep the compliance calendar.	Audit plan, nonconformity log, corrective action reports, KPI dashboard
Operations Manager	Ensure seafood receiving, inspection, vessel authorization, species catalog use, and cold chain controls are implemented consistently.	Receiving records, temperature logs, supplier/vessel records, hold/release decisions
HSE Coordinator	Maintain safety procedures, emergency response readiness, incident reporting, and evidence for worker safety and site emergency controls.	Safety inspections, drills, incident reports, training attendance
HR Manager	Maintain employee onboarding, leave/benefits, training attendance, role competence, ethical labor evidence, and employee communication records.	Training files, HR policies, attendance records, employee acknowledgments
IT/System Owner	Protect access to BlueTrack and corporate systems, support traceability records, and retain system evidence for audit review.	Access logs, user authorization records, system change records
Document Control Owner	Maintain document inventory, ownership, ingestion plan, curation criteria, access permissions, and revision traceability.	Document inventory, ownership matrix, access permissions, revision history

5. Certification Scope by Process Area

The certification framework is translated into everyday process controls. Each area must be able to show what it does, who is responsible, which record proves performance, and how exceptions are escalated.

Process Area	Relevant Standards	Expected Control
Corporate documents	ISO 9001, BRCGS, IFS	Documents must be approved, versioned, searchable, retained, and assigned to a clear owner.
Human resources	SMETA, ISO 9001, BRCGS, IFS	Employees must receive role-relevant induction, policy access,

Process Area	Relevant Standards	Expected Control
		competence review, and fair labor communication.
HSE	SMETA, BASC, BRCGS, IFS	Safety risks, emergency response, PPE, drills, incidents, and contractor safety controls must be documented.
Fishing vessels and sourcing	MSC Chain of Custody, BASC, BRCGS, IFS	Authorized sources must be verified, documented, and linked to receiving and traceability records.
Receiving and inspection	HACCP, BRCGS, IFS, MSC	Product must be checked for identity, condition, temperature, documentation, and eligibility before acceptance.
Cold chain	HACCP, BRCGS, IFS	Temperature limits, deviations, corrective actions, and release decisions must be recorded and reviewed.
Corrective action	ISO 9001, BRCGS, IFS, SMETA	Nonconformities must be contained, investigated, corrected, verified, and trended.
Systems access	BASC, ISO 9001, BRCGS	Only authorized users may access records; access changes must be controlled and traceable.

6. Evidence Model

Audit readiness depends on evidence that is complete, current, attributable, legible, retrievable, and aligned with the requirement it supports. Evidence must never be created after the fact to fill a gap without identifying the actual gap and corrective action.

- Complete: includes all fields needed to understand the decision, result, date, person responsible, and follow-up.
- Current: reflects the latest approved process, customer requirement, or certification scope.
- Attributable: identifies the person, role, system, or source responsible for the record.
- Legible and usable: can be read, exported, indexed, or reviewed without ambiguity.
- Retrievable: stored in an approved location with access aligned to document permissions.
- Linked: connected to related evidence such as vessel authorization, receiving inspection, temperature monitoring, nonconformity, and release decision.

7. Audit Readiness Cycle

BlueSea Foods maintains a practical audit readiness cycle. The goal is to avoid last-minute document collection and to make compliance part of normal operations.

1. Maintain the document inventory and confirm that each active document has an owner, format, review date, and access rule.
2. Review the compliance calendar monthly and identify certification audits, customer audits, supplier reviews, internal audits, and management review milestones.
3. Sample high-risk records every month: cold chain deviations, receiving holds, corrective actions, vessel authorizations, training records, and access changes.
4. Escalate gaps to the relevant owner with due date, risk level, evidence expected, and verification method.

5. Verify closure by reviewing the corrected record and confirming that recurrence risk has been reduced.
6. Trend findings for management review and update training, procedures, or system controls when repeated issues are identified.

8. Compliance Controls and Monitoring

The following controls are monitored to maintain the certification framework. They should be reviewed during internal audits and management review.

Control	Frequency	Owner	Acceptance Criteria
Document inventory review	Monthly	Document Control Owner	No active document lacks owner, format, status, or access classification.
Cold chain exception review	Weekly	Operations Manager	All deviations have disposition and corrective action where required.
Receiving inspection sampling	Weekly	QA Supervisor	Inspection records are complete and linked to vessel/source/species data.
Vessel authorization review	Monthly	Operations Manager	No expired or unapproved source is used for certified product.
Training matrix review	Quarterly	HR Manager	Mandatory training completion meets the target threshold.
Emergency drill review	Semiannual	HSE Coordinator	Drill records include scenario, attendance, gaps, and action owners.
Internal audit	Annual or risk-based	QA Manager	Audit plan covers QMS, food safety, traceability, safety, and document control.
Management review	Annual	Corporate Management	KPIs, risks, nonconformities, resources, and improvement actions are reviewed.

9. Nonconformity and Corrective Action Interface

A finding, deviation, customer complaint, audit observation, expired authorization, incomplete record, temperature excursion, or traceability failure may become a nonconformity. The detailed workflow is governed by BSF-QMS-003, but this overview defines when escalation is required.

- Immediate containment is required when food safety, legal status, certified claim integrity, worker safety, or supply chain security may be affected.
- Root cause analysis is required for repeated findings, major audit findings, customer-impacting failures, and any gap involving certified product claims.
- Corrective action effectiveness must be verified using objective evidence, not only a statement that the issue was corrected.

10. Key Performance Indicators

KPI	Definition	Target	Review
Audit closure timeliness	Percent of internal and external audit actions closed by due date.	>= 95%	Monthly
Record completeness	Percent of sampled compliance records meeting completion	>= 98%	Monthly

KPI	Definition	Target	Review
	criteria.		
Training completion	Mandatory quality, safety, and compliance training completed by assigned employees.	>= 95%	Quarterly
Traceability test success	Percent of traceability exercises completed within target time with complete links.	100%	Quarterly
Cold chain deviation closure	Temperature deviations with disposition and action recorded within required timeframe.	>= 98%	Weekly
Document review currency	Controlled documents reviewed before scheduled review date.	>= 95%	Monthly

11. Risk Register Summary

Certification risk is managed through ownership, monitoring, and evidence quality. The table below summarizes recurring risk areas that should be reviewed before audits.

Risk	Potential Impact	Preventive Control
Expired or incomplete source authorization	Loss of certified claim integrity, customer rejection, or audit finding.	Monthly vessel/source review linked to receiving controls.
Incomplete receiving evidence	Weak traceability, product release uncertainty, or food safety concern.	Mandatory receiving checklist and QA verification.
Temperature deviation without disposition	Food safety risk and inability to prove product control.	Cold chain register review and documented hold/release decision.
Uncontrolled document versions	Employees may follow obsolete instructions.	Document inventory, ownership matrix, and access policy controls.
Training gaps	Inconsistent execution and SMETA/BRCGS/IFS findings.	Training matrix review and supervisor escalation.
System access not updated	Unauthorized record changes or weak audit trail.	Access request, periodic review, and removal on role change.

12. Records and Retention

Records must be retained according to the corporate document standard, customer requirements, certification requirements, and legal obligations. Where retention periods differ, the stricter requirement should be applied unless Legal or Corporate Management approves another approach.

Record Family	Examples	Primary Owner
Certification files	Audit plans, audit reports, certification scope, management review evidence	Quality Assurance Manager
Operational records	Receiving inspection, temperature logs, hold/release decisions, vessel/source approvals	Operations Manager
HACCP and food safety	Hazard review, monitoring records, deviations, corrective actions	Quality Assurance Manager
HR and training	Induction records, training attendance, policy acknowledgments, benefits policy evidence	HR Manager
HSE	Safety inspections, emergency drills, incident reports, PPE checks	HSE Coordinator
IT and access	User access approvals, access reviews, system change records	IT/System Owner
Document control	Inventory, ownership matrix, source plan, curation criteria, access policy	Document Control Owner

13. Internal Document References

The following internal documents support this overview and should be available during document review, internal audit, or external audit preparation.

Code	Document
BSF-CORP-001	Corporate Profile
BSF-CORP-002	Corporate Glossary
BSF-DOC-STD-001	Corporate Document Standard
BSF-CORP-003	Corporate Organization Chart
BSF-CORP-004	Corporate Knowledge Map
BSF-HR-001	Employee Onboarding Guide
BSF-HR-002	Employee FAQ
BSF-HR-003	Leave and Benefits Policy
BSF-HSE-001	Workplace Safety Procedure
BSF-HSE-002	Emergency Response Guide
BSF-OPS-001	Cold Chain Control Register
BSF-OPS-002	Authorized Fishing Vessels
BSF-OPS-003	Seafood Species Catalog
BSF-OPS-004	Seafood Receiving and Inspection Procedure
BSF-QMS-001	Quality Management Induction
BSF-QMS-003	Corrective Action and Nonconformity Procedure
BSF-IT-001	BlueTrack User Manual
BSF-IT-002	Corporate Systems Access Guide
BSF-INV-001	Document Inventory
BSF-INV-002	Document Ownership Matrix
BSF-INV-003	Document Sources and Ingestion Plan
BSF-INV-004	Document Curation and Quality Criteria
BSF-INV-005	Access and Permissions Policy

14. External Standards References

This document is aligned at a high level with the following standards and schemes. It is not a substitute for the official standard text, certification body interpretation, or customer-specific compliance requirements.

- ISO 9001 - Quality management systems requirements.
- Codex Alimentarius HACCP / General Principles of Food Hygiene.
- BRCGS Food Safety - food safety, legality, quality, and operational control expectations.
- IFS Food - food safety and quality requirements for processing and supplier assurance contexts.
- MSC Chain of Custody - traceability and certified seafood claim integrity.
- BASC - supply chain security and international trade control framework.
- SMETA / Sedex - ethical trade, labor, health and safety, environment, and business ethics audit framework.

Appendix A. Audit Preparation Checklist

- Confirm scope, sites, products, processes, and certification claims under review.
- Retrieve current controlled versions of relevant procedures, policies, and registers.
- Sample receiving, cold chain, vessel/source, training, HSE, access, and corrective action evidence.
- Verify that open actions have owners, due dates, status, and objective evidence of progress.
- Confirm that employees likely to be interviewed understand their role, records, and escalation path.
- Prepare traceability examples that link vessel/source, species catalog, receiving record, cold chain control, and release decision.
- Review customer-specific requirements and confirm whether they add stricter evidence expectations.
- Hold a pre-audit readiness meeting with Quality, Operations, HR, HSE, IT, and Document Control.

Appendix B. Review and Update Rules

This document shall be reviewed at least annually or earlier when:

- a certification scope changes;
- a new standard, customer requirement, or regulatory requirement is adopted;
- an audit identifies a systemic weakness in compliance ownership or evidence retrieval;
- new systems or data sources are introduced into the RAG/documentation project;
- BlueSea Foods changes core operational processes affecting seafood receiving, cold chain, traceability, or product release.

Document Approval

Role	Name	Signature / Approval	Date
Prepared by	Quality Documentation Specialist		
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